

Top Secret

Case 002

OPERATION LOOKBOOK

A 50K creator. A highly trusted audience. A business increasingly bottlenecked by her own judgement.

BRIEFING 01

THE ASSIGNMENT

THE ASK

ONE PRODUCT // 8 HOURS

BUILD ONE WORKING PRODUCT THAT USES SOFIA'S JUDGEMENT TO HELP ONE REAL AUDIENCE MEMBER MAKE ONE BETTER DECISION.

DELIVERABLE

A working demo you can show in under a minute. Not a deck.

CHECKPOINTS

16:00 intelligence drop. 18:00 Judging. 19:00 top six pitch.

JUDGED ON

Value to a real audience member. Focus to her judgement. Use of the evidence. Does it work.

THE TARGET

Sofia Bennett. Fashion creator, stylist, trusted taste-maker. 50K followers. Sofia plus one part-time VA.

THE MISSION

Turn Sofia's taste into something her audience can actually use – without turning her into a catalogue.

50K

TOTAL FOLLOWERS

3.1K+

DMS / MONTH

2.4M

AVG MONTHLY REACH

8 hrs

TO SHIP THE PROOF

GROUND RULES

- 01 Start hacking immediately.
- 02 You do not need AI or expensive model calls.
- 03 Use the evidence. Ignore the theatre.
- 04 A simple product that works beats a complicated demo.

WHAT PEOPLE WANT

Not another list of links. They want Sofia to decide: what would I buy, what would I wear, what is worth it, and what fits my life?

WHAT SOFIA WANTS

More audience intimacy, not less. Less repetitive admin, more time spent making content and finding great products.

BRIEFING 02

SUBJECT FILE

Subject classification: creator-led commerce.

VISUAL ON FILE

WITHHELD

SOFIA BENNETT

27 // London

34K Instagram 16K TikTok

FASHION / STYLING

REF LBK-002-SUBJ

VERIFIED

REPUTATION

Sofia has an audience that treats her like their best-dressed friend. They believe she can save them from bad purchases and bad styling decisions.

SUPERPOWER Taste + trust

CHANNELS Instagram + TikTok

REVENUE Affiliate + brand + UGC

ALSO Paid styling + creator-led edits

TEAM Sofia + 1 PT VA

MONTHLY REACH 2.4M

HER RULE

"I would rather link 3 things I truly love than 30 things I was paid to post."

Assessment: her taste is the asset. The value of her judgement is still trapped inside the creator.

BRIEFING 03

KNOWN ASSOCIATES

Small enough to feel personal. Large enough to become impossible to answer one by one.

THE DECIDER

HIGH INTENT

"Tell me which one."

Wants Sofia to narrow the choice.

THE RECREATOR

SAVES / SHARES

"How do I get this vibe?"

Wants the look, not necessarily the exact item.

THE VALUE HUNTER

COMPARES

"Anything like this under £100?"

Wants the same taste at a lower price.

THE STYLIST

HIGH REPEAT

"What would you wear with this?"

Wants styling around what they already own.

THE FRIEND

INVISIBLE

"Sending this to you."

Shares with someone else who might buy. Often invisible to last-click.

NOTE

The audience does not behave like one audience.

ASSESSMENT The strongest product may serve a decision, a taste system, or a social behaviour rather than a shopping link.

E-01 THE INBOX

These are not all the same question. Read the subtext.

E-01.1 @jessicam EXACT ITEM REQUEST
"WHERE is this blazer I'm
begging you"

E-01.3 @niamhh ADAPTATION
"I love the outfit but I live
in trainers. How would you
change it?"

E-01.5 @sarahk SOCIAL SHARING
"Sending this to my sister
because she needs this exact
vibe"

E-01.7 @sophiaa INTENT
"Can you find me a version of
this for a wedding? Same
energy, less corporate."

E-01.9 @laura CONSTRAINT
"I'm trying not to buy more
stuff. Can you help me use what
I own?"

E-01.11 @georgia SECOND-HAND DISCOVERY
"My bf sent me your coat video
because he thinks I need it"

E-01.2 @amelie.paris DECISION
"Ok but if you were me, which
one would you actually buy?"

E-01.4 @roisin BUDGET
"Anything like this but under
£120? I'm not paying £400 lol"

E-01.6 @hannah FIT
"What size are you in this? I'm
usually an 8 but brands are all
over the place."

E-01.8 @maya_m POST-PURCHASE
"I bought the shoes. What
should I wear with them?"

E-01.10 @rachel TRUST
"This is the first creator
account where I actually save
everything."

E-01.12 @ameliax CONSIDERATION
"I've opened this three times.
Still deciding."

CLUE E-01 Twelve messages, seven different jobs. Underneath all of
them: *decide for me the way you would decide for
yourself.*

E-02

FIELD NOTES // SOFIA'S TUESDAY

Surveillance log. One ordinary working day.

07:45	Coffee + checks DMs	12 unread "where is this?" messages
09:00	Film content	Outfit details saved as voice notes
11:00	Edit + captions	Adds links manually
12:30	Brand call	Negotiating a capsule campaign
14:00	DM sprint	Answers 38 useful questions
15:30	Affiliate admin	Copies links into replies
17:00	Content planning	Saves 11 outfit screenshots
19:30	Dinner	Friend sends her a look to recreate
21:00	Second DM sprint	Still 90+ unanswered
23:10	One last check	"Tomorrow I need to fix this."

CLUE E-02

Two DM sprints a day and the queue still grows. The bottleneck is not effort. It is that her judgement only exists in real time.

E-03 BROADCAST LOG

The posts that matter. Reach is loud. Intent is quiet.

E-03.1	"3 outfits I'd wear to London Fashion Week"	61K views	4.8K saves	218 purchases	Strong conversion
E-03.2	"Everything I wore in Copenhagen"	184K views	7.1K saves	92 purchases	High reach, low intent
E-03.3	"£100 outfit challenge"	42K views	6.9K saves	311 purchases	High intent
E-03.4	"The blazer I keep wearing"	28K views	3.8K saves	427 purchases	Quiet winner
E-03.5	"Things I would never buy again"	39K views	5.3K saves	0 purchases	High trust, low direct revenue

WIDEST REACH

184K views produced 92 purchases.

SMALLEST REACH

28K views produced 427.

CLUE E-03 The most-watched post is not the strongest commercial signal. Read the behaviour, not the vanity metric.

E-04

INVENTORY // THE WARDROBE

Extract: 8 of 36 items. A product is not the same thing as a recommendation.

REF	ITEM	CATEGORY	PRICE	SIZE	STYLE	STATUS	SOFIA SAYS
E-04.1	Black blazer	Jacket	£145	UK 8	Tailored	In stock	"buy once, wear forever"
E-04.2	Vintage leather	Jacket	£180	UK 8	Vintage	One-off	"great, but warm"
E-04.3	Silk skirt	Skirt	£95	UK 8	Minimal	In stock	"best with trainers"
E-04.4	White tee	Top	£35	UK 8	Basic	In stock	"£35 is enough"
E-04.5	Loafers	Shoes	£120	UK 5	Classic	In stock	"expensive-ish, worth it"
E-04.6	Red slingback	Shoes	£89	UK 5	Statement	In stock	"date-night shoe"
E-04.7	Grey knit	Top	£78	UK S	Minimal	Low stock	"soft but pills"
E-04.8	Wide-leg denim	Trousers	£110	UK 8	Relaxed	In stock	"my actual uniform"

USEFUL FIELDS

Price

Style

Availability

Fit

Sofia rating

Personal note

"Would I buy again?"

DATA NOTE

The dataset intentionally mixes objective facts with Sofia’s subjective judgement. The subjective layer is not noise. It is the product.

E-05 RECOVERED NOTEBOOK

Sofia's own notes. Messy on purpose. Useful on purpose.

E-05.1

BUY / MAYBE / NO

Black blazer – best one
Vintage leather – looks
insane, too warm
Loafers – buy once, keep
forever
White tee – £35 version is
enough

*"if I wouldn't text this to
my sister, I don't link it."*

E-05.2 // QUESTIONS I KEEP ANSWERING

where is it?
what size?
cheaper?
what goes with it?

E-05.3 // IDEAS, UNFINISHED

let people tell me what
they already own
maybe the answer is not a
shop

E-05.4 // REMINDER TO SELF

STOP MAKING [REDACTED]. CURATE
5.

E-05.5 // HANDWRITTEN MARGIN

*"People want my eye, not my
inventory."*

E-05.6 // CONTRADICTION

She keeps saying "less links."
But her highest-converting posts
are also the most curated. The
opportunity may be less about
reducing links and more about
making each recommendation carry
more of Sofia's context.

E-06

SOFIA, UNFILTERED

Audio ID: SOFIA-VOICE-02. Scan the case QR to hear the original recording.

E-06.1 // VOICE NOTE01:42



"I actually like answering people. It is why the community feels like a community. I just don't want my business model to require me to be awake every time someone wants my opinion. If something could capture how I think about clothes – not just what I own – that would be useful."

QR
PLACEHOLDER

E-06.2 // AUDIO

E-06.3 // LISTEN FOR THIS

- / "how I think"
- / "not just what I own"
- / "community feels like a community"
- / "without me being awake"

E-07

FOUR PEOPLE, FOUR JOBS

Tracked individuals from the audience intelligence file.

SUBJECT PHOTO WITHHELD	SUBJECT PHOTO WITHHELD
E-07.1 CLARA / 23 Wants a look for less. Views 6 times, saves, then searches herself. LOW CLICK / HIGH PURCHASE	E-07.2 JAMIE / 29 Owns basics. Wants styling help. Returns to old posts and asks follow-ups. HIGH REPEAT
SUBJECT PHOTO WITHHELD	SUBJECT PHOTO WITHHELD
E-07.3 PRIYA / 31 Wants Sofia's "buy once" judgement. Saves "worth it" posts. HIGH AOV	E-07.4 ELLA / 26 Sends outfits to friends. Friend often makes the purchase. LOW ATTRIBUTION

CHAIN OF CUSTODY Behavioural records logged by organiser. Anonymised before release.

E-08

STEAL THE TASTE

Your mission is not to build a better link page. It is to make Sofia's judgement useful at scale.

THE OBJECTIVE

ONE PRODUCT. ONE AUDIENCE MEMBER. ONE DECISION MADE BETTER.

Pick a person from the evidence, pick the decision they are stuck on, and ship the thing that answers it the way Sofia would. If you cannot name the person and the decision, you do not have a product yet.

YOUR BUILD MUST

- E-08.1 Help a real audience member make a better decision.
- E-08.2 Preserve a meaningful piece of Sofia's judgement / taste.
- E-08.3 Work with the evidence provided.
- E-08.4 Be demonstrable in a few clicks.
- E-08.5 Not require expensive AI inference to be impressive.

THINGS YOU DO NOT NEED

A giant model.
A huge backend.
A pitch deck pretending it is a product.

STANDING ORDER

You have 8 hours. Ship the sharpest proof of your idea, not the largest codebase.

Intelligence Drop

DO NOT OPEN UNTIL 16:00

This envelope contains information that should change how you think about the case. Do not photograph it before then. One new dataset. One uncomfortable finding. One decision you now have to make.

ORGANISER NOTE: PRINT THIS SHEET AS THE OUTER FACE OF AN OPAQUE ENVELOPE. THE INTELLIGENCE ITSELF IS THE NEXT SHEET. THE ROOM SHOULD NOTICE WHEN THIS OPENS.

Sealed

E-09

YOU HAVE BEEN LOOKING AT THE WRONG SIGNAL

We analysed Sofia's last 90 days of audience behaviour.

FINDING // E-09.1

THE PURCHASE IS OFTEN NOT THE CLICK

People use Sofia to decide, then buy later, sometimes somewhere else. The value is being undercounted by the obvious metrics.

E-09.2

62%

of high-value purchasers did not click Sofia's affiliate link

E-09.3

3.4 days

median time between saving Sofia's content and purchase

E-09.4

41%

of purchases followed a share to a friend or partner

E-09.5

2.2x

higher purchase rate when a person saved 3+ looks before buying

YOUR 30-MINUTE WINDOW

Reassess your product. What behaviour are you actually designing for?

E-10

WHAT HAPPENS BEFORE THE SALE

Intent data released at 16:00.

USER	SAVES	SHARES	RETURNS	LINK CLICK	PURCHASE	DAYS TO BUY
U-014	7	2	4	NO	YES	5
U-031	2	0	1	YES	YES	0.4
U-067	5	3	3	NO	YES	4
U-082	1	0	1	YES	NO	—
U-104	8	5	6	NO	YES	7
U-121	3	1	2	NO	YES	2
U-139	6	4	3	NO	YES	3
U-166	1	0	1	YES	NO	—
U-204	9	6	7	NO	YES	6
U-219	4	0	2	YES	YES	1
U-241	2	2	2	NO	NO	—
U-288	7	4	5	NO	YES	4

LOOK CLOSER

The YES/NO around link clicks is intentionally incomplete. You are supposed to decide what matters, then decide what to instrument. Signal can be behavioural, not transactional.

BRIEFING 04 // CONTACT

THE JUDGING

At 18:00, the Judges take their stand

THE RULE

For the demo, don't just tell what you've built - show how it makes their life easier.

01 WOULD I USE IT?

Does this solve a real problem in my actual workflow?

02 WOULD I TRUST IT?

Does it preserve the thing my audience actually comes to me for?

03 WOULD MY AUDIENCE USE IT?

Does it make a decision easier, faster or better?

04 WOULD I SHARE IT?

Would I put this in my content / bio / DMs tomorrow?

EXFILTRATION

Eyes only

THE GETAWAY

90 seconds. Product first. No deck.

30 sec

THE TARGET

What were you stealing?

90 sec

THE HEIST

Show us the product.

60 sec

THE SCORE

Show us the impact.

FINAL LINE

"Sofia no longer needs to _____ because
_____."

SHIP IT